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1945

F

JAPAN

F 7141
19 SEP 1945

76

Registry Number F} 7141/630/23

TELEGRAM FROM
Earl of Halifax,
Washington.

No. 6286
6287

Dated 18th Sept.,

Received in Registry } 19th Sept., 1945.

F: Japan

Control of Japan.

Text of a statement to be issued by General MacArthur on 20th September giving the Supreme Commander authority to rule the state and instructions for policy to be adopted in the control of Japan.

Last Paper.

F 7138

References.

(*Print.*)

(*How disposed of.*)

(Action completed.)

RD 27/9

(Index.)

10

Next Paper.

F 7150.

(*Minutes.*)

Washington tel No 6287 of Sept 18th.
An amended copy of No 6287, correcting the name Siosan to Sansom, has been issued:

A.J. de la Mare
20/9

We have already had this information in a J.S.M. Washington tel. which shows that this directive was issued to General MacArthur on the 6th Sept.

With ref. to para. 3 of tel. No. 6287 if this is the American idea of consultation it is a very embryonic plant. To quote the American idiom, they are not asking us, they are telling us.

L.H. Foulds
20/9

The text of this statement as given in a JSM Tel has already been submitted to the S of S as an example of the kind of unilateral action which the US Govt are taking without any pretence of consultation with us; & as a reason why it is urgently necessary to clear/

23138 11/41 F.O.P.

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clear the present deadlock about the machinery for the control of Japan.

J.S.B.
Sept. 22

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F 414 |630|23

*** AMENDED COPY ***

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[CYPHER]

CABINET DISTRIBUTION

FROM WASHINGTON TO FOREIGN OFFICE

Earl of Halifax
No. 6287
18th September, 1945.

D. 9.40 p.m. 18th September, 1945.
R. 4.45 a.m. 19th September, 1945

5 5 5 5

IMPORTANT

My immediately preceding telegram.

In handing statement to * Sansom,* Vincent said that he was going to hand copies to the Chinese and Russians after which MacArthur would be told that he could issue it.

2. Vincent did not (repeat not) ask for your views on the statement.

3. Idea of informing us that statement was to be made was evidently connected in his mind with the need for closer consultation on policy towards Japan, as he went on to ask whether I had yet received any reply from you to United States proposals for a Far East Advisory Commission.

O.T.P.

20/9

20 SEP 1945
F.O. REGI

266 7 F

[This telegram is of particular secrecy and should be retained by the authorised recipient and not passed on]

[CYPHER] **CABINET DISTRIBUTION**

FROM WASHINGTON TO FOREIGN OFFICE

Earl of Halifax
No. 6286 D. 12.50 a.m. 19th September, 1945
18th September, 1945 R. 6.45 a.m. 19th September, 1945

ddddddd

IMPORTANT

Following is text of a statement to be issued by General MacArthur probably on 20th September.

The authority of The Emperor and the Japanese Government to rule the State is subordinate to you as Supreme Commander for the Allied Powers. You will exercise your authority as you deem proper to carry out your mission. Our relations with Japan do not rest on a contractual basis, but on an unconditional surrender. Since your authority is supreme, you will not entertain any question on the part of the Japanese as to its scope.

2. Control of Japan shall be exercised through the Japanese Government to the extent that such an arrangement produces satisfactory results. This does not prejudice your right to act directly if required. You may enforce the orders issued by you by the employment of such measures as you deem necessary, including the use of force.

3. The statement of intentions contained in the Potsdam Declaration will be given full effect. It will not be given effect, however, because we consider ourselves bound in a contractual relationship with Japan as a result of that document. It will be respected and given effect because the Potsdam Declaration forms a part of our policy stated in good faith with relation to Japan and with relation to peace and security in the Far East.

See my immediately following telegram.

O.T.P.

19 SEP 1945

19 SEP 1945
F.O. REGISTRY

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[CYPHER] **CABINET DISTRIBUTION**

FROM WASHINGTON TO FOREIGN OFFICE

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No.6287
18th September, 1945. R. 4.45 a.m. 19th September, 1945.

... ...

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O.T.P.

F [illegible]
19 SEP 1945

19 SEP 1945
F.O. REGISTRY

SB At the risk of butting in, may I just corroborate 3 from personal experience? Ballantine was always frightened of his own shadow (if any) & Dickover didn't know anything. Vincent is an altogether different proposition & has always tried to help whenever I have asked him anything. with apologies Paul Gore-Booth

[This telegram is of particular secrecy and should be retained by the authorised recipient and not passed on].

[CYPHER]

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